

Overview of Database (as of July 31, 2021)

This database is designed to allow users to quickly sort, filter, and use information regarding the economic integration of bilateral country pairings. The primary resource is in the Excel file titled **“EIA Database July 31 2021 (with links)”**. Below is an overview of the document itself as well as ways to maximize its functionality.

Overview of Excel Document

The primary Excel file has four main tabs:

- 1) “Country List” contains a list of the countries in the dataset and identification numbers used consistently throughout the document.
- 2) “Definitions” provides a table showing the classifications used throughout the document and their definitions.
- 3) “Data Sheet” is the primary resource in the document and contains an array with rows that correspond in bilateral pairings and yearly columns. The agreements are shown from Exporter to Importer (Columns A & D).
- 4) “Comments & PDF Links” contains explanations for the reported values on the Data Sheet. All entries will contain at least one hyperlink to a PDF file for documentation. PDFs may be found within the “PDF Files” folder. Though Column B shows the Exporter Country, while Column E shows the Importer Country, it is important to note that Column A shows the relationship in Importer-Exporter order¹. Column Q provides a link to the agreement in the reverse order where the importer is the exporter and vice versa.

Moving Through the Database

Within the Data Sheet, the values across rows will change to reflect updated trade statuses between the two countries. This change will either reflect country coming into or out of existence as a recognized “country” or a change in the “level” of economic integration with another country, such as a free trade agreement. At every change there is a hyperlink (blue for changes in numerical values representing a bilateral agreement and orange when a country enters the dataset as a recognized “country” by the rest of the world). Clicking on this hyperlink will automatically redirect to the corresponding row on the “Comments & PDF Links” page which provides explanations and documentation for the change.

¹ Due to internal functions that have no bearing on the data, Column A needs to be formatted Importer-Exporter-Year, as opposed to Exporter-Importer-Year.

Sorting and Filtering

Given the size of the database (23,201 pairings over 68 years) a premium is put on the ability to filter data. There are three primary ways to achieve this:

- 1) After adding filters, the drop down menus on the top of the A and D columns allow the user to restrict data shown to certain countries.²
- 2) A similar method can be used to sort by the ID numbers in the B and E columns. This is a particularly useful method because the ID numbers will automatically update based on the values entered on the “Country List”.³ For example, if a user would like to restrict the Data Set shown to members of the EU, just change the values on the Country List to “0” for all non EU countries and then filter the Data Sheet B and E columns so that only non-zero numbers are returned. Use the “custom” option if the standard choices do not have your desired filter.
- 3) The final tool is filtering the “Sort Pair” column. This column will return “0” if both country IDs in the pair are zero, “1” if only one of them is not zero, and “2” if both IDs are non-zero. For example, if you want all entries for Luxemburg but are unsure which column it is listed in you can change all values to “0” except for Luxemburg and then filter for Sort Pair “1” and all entries with Luxemburg on either side should appear. A particularly useful variant of this method is to number the members of a regional agreement (such as the EU) in the order in which they entered the agreement and change all other countries to “0”. You can then sort by ID number which will rearrange members of the EU by the date they joined. A sort pair of “2” would return intra-EU relations and “1” would return pairing only of EU countries with non-EU countries.

² As of May 31, 2013, country pairings are listed going both directions (e.g. Belgium-France exists, as does France-Belgium). They are listed as separate entries.

³ If you have manual (i.e. not automatic) calculations turned on for Excel, you will need to press F9 after changing ID numbers for the calculations to take effect.